

Key Topic 1: The Birth of the State of Israel, 1945–63

Comprehensive Mastery & Exam Practice Booklet · Foundation to Grade 9 · 1945–1963

Pupil Name: _____

Class / Set: _____

Target Grade: []

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER (GCSE 9–1)

Marked by Teacher or Peer Verified

Assessment Component & Stem Focus	Format Style	Max Marks	Score	RAG Status
Complete Knowledge Vault (All 80 Recall Questions)	Checklist	/80	_____	[R] [A] [G]
Round 1 (Stepped): Q1 Consequence (bombing of the King David Hotel...)	Ladder	/4	_____	[] L1 [] L2
Round 1 (Stepped): Q2 Importance (UN Resolution 181 for the creation...)	Ladder	/8	_____	[] L2 [] L3
Round 1 (Stepped): Q3 Narrative Account (key events of the Arab-Israeli...)	Ladder	/8	_____	[] L2 [] L3
Round 2 (Dual-Track): Q1 Consequence (Israeli attacks on Gaza in 195...)	Dual Track	/4	_____	[] L1 [] L2
Round 2 (Dual-Track): Q2 Importance (Law of Return (1950) for the new...)	Dual Track	/8	_____	[] L2 [] L3
Round 2 (Dual-Track): Q3 Narrative Account (key events of the Suez Crisis ...)	Dual Track	/8	_____	[] L2 [] L3
Round 3 (Simulation): Q1 Consequence (formation of the United Arab R...)	Exam Hall	/4	_____	[] L1 [] L2
Round 3 (Simulation): Q2 Importance (creation of the Israeli Defence...)	Exam Hall	/8	_____	[] L2 [] L3
Round 3 (Simulation): Q3 Narrative Account (key events leading to the end ...)	Exam Hall	/8	_____	[] L2 [] L3
TOTAL COMBINED EXAM MARKS:		/60	_____ / 60	Grade: [9 8 7 6 5 4]

Teacher / Marker Signature: _____

Date Completed: _____

EDEXCEL EXAM FAST FACTS & STEM BLUEPRINTS (OPTION P5 PERIOD STUDY)

TOTAL PAPER 2: 32 MARKS · 50 MINS

- **4-Mark Consequence (~6 mins):** *P-F-C Formula*. State **Point** clearly in sentence 1 \$ \rightarrow \$ support with **2–3 detailed facts** \$ \rightarrow \$ explain direct **Consequence Link** (why this mattered).
- **8-Mark Narrative Account (~12 mins):** *T-P-C Storyboard*. 3 linked paragraphs: **Trigger / Outbreak** \$ \rightarrow \$ **Decisive Turning Point** \$ \rightarrow \$ **Climax / Outcome**. Must use explicit causal connectives showing how Stage 1 caused Stage 2.
- **8-Mark Importance (~12 mins each):** *F-I-L Formula*. Identify **Factor** \$ \rightarrow \$ provide **Information facts** \$ \rightarrow \$ explain causal **Link** showing directly why it was important *for the named outcome*.

KEY TOPIC 1: THE BIRTH OF THE STATE OF ISRAEL, 1945–63

Complete Knowledge Retrieval Vault · Questions 1 to 40 (No notes! Check your recall)

VAULT PART 1

- ☐ 1. What crucial man-made waterway connects the Mediterranean Sea to the Red Sea, serving as a vital strategic chokepoint for international trade and oil?
[KT1]
- ☐ 2. Which strategic maritime passage at the mouth of the Gulf of Aqaba was blockaded by Egypt in 1956 and 1967, acts that Israel considered causes of war?
[KT1]
- ☐ 3. Which triangular desert peninsula connecting Africa to Asia was captured by Israel from Egypt in 1956 and 1967, before being returned under the Camp David Accords?
[KT1]
- ☐ 4. Which strategic river forms the natural eastern boundary of the West Bank, flowing south from the Sea of Galilee into the Dead Sea?
[KT1]
- ☐ 5. Which ancient and holy city, claimed as a capital by both Israelis and Palestinians, was divided between 1948 and 1967 before Israeli forces captured the Old City?
[KT1]
- ☐ 6. Which elevated volcanic plateau bordering south-western Syria was captured by Israel during the 1967 Six Day War due to its dominant military vantage point over Galilee?
[KT1]
- ☐ 7. Which narrow coastal strip bordering Egypt's Sinai Peninsula came under Egyptian military control in 1948, was captured by Israel in 1967, and became an epicenter of the 1987 Intifada?
[KT1]
- ☐ 8. Which territory west of the River Jordan was annexed by Jordan in 1950, occupied by Israel in 1967, and became the central focus of Jewish settlement expansion?
[KT1]
- ☐ 9. What was the de facto border established by the 1949 Armistice Agreements separating Israel from the West Bank, Gaza Strip, and Golan Heights until 1967?
[KT1]
- ☐ 10. Which arid southern desert region accounted for over 55% of the total land area allocated to the Jewish state under the 1947 UN Partition Plan?
[KT1]
- ☐ 11. Which southern Israeli port city on the Gulf of Aqaba provides Israel with maritime access to the Red Sea, East Africa, and Asia without using the Suez Canal?
[KT1]
- ☐ 12. Which strategic fortified coastal town at the southern tip of the Sinai Peninsula directly commands the entrance to the Straits of Tiran?
[KT1]
- ☐ 13. Which major freshwater lake in northern Israel, fed by the River Jordan, was a frequent source of border clashes with Syria in the 1950s and 1960s?
[KT1]
- ☐ 14. Which region north of Israel's border became known as 'Fatahland' in the 1970s as the PLO launched cross-border rocket attacks against northern Israeli towns?
[KT1]
- ☐ 15. What was the massive Israeli chain of sand-wall fortifications built along the eastern bank of the Suez Canal after 1967 to defend against an Egyptian crossing?
[KT1]
- ☐ 16. Which capital city was subjected to a brutal three-month siege and heavy IDF bombardment in the summer of 1982, leading to the evacuation of the PLO to Tunisia?
[KT1]
- ☐ 17. What was the political movement that emerged in the late 19th century advocating for the establishment of a sovereign Jewish national homeland in Palestine?
[KT1]
- ☐ 18. What was the primary conflict between Arab and Jewish demands in Palestine as the British Mandate drew to a close in 1945?
[KT1]
- ☐ 19. Which neighboring Arab kingdom east of the River Jordan, ruled by King Abdullah I, annexed the West Bank and East Jerusalem following the 1948–49 War?
[KT1]
- ☐ 20. In 1945 at the end of the Second World War, what was the approximate demographic balance of the population living in Mandatory Palestine?
[KT1]
- ☐ 21. Why was British Foreign Secretary Ernest Bevin determined to maintain strict immigration quotas to Palestine in 1945–46?
[KT1.1]
- ☐ 22. What tragic event on 22 July 1946 broke British civilian morale and accelerated their withdrawal from Palestine?
[KT1.1]
- ☐ 23. Which refugee ship carrying 4,500 Holocaust survivors was intercepted by the British Royal Navy in July 1947 and forcibly returned to displaced persons camps in Germany?
[KT1.1]
- ☐ 24. What did United Nations Resolution 181 (passed on 29 November 1947) propose for Palestine?
[KT1.1]
- ☐ 25. What was the Jewish Agency's reaction to UN Resolution 181 compared to that of the Arab Higher Committee?
[KT1.1]
- ☐ 26. What was the primary military objective of the Haganah's 'Plan Dalet' (Plan D) launched in April 1948?
[KT1.1]
- ☐ 27. What notorious event on 9 April 1948 involved an Irgun and Lehi attack on an Arab village, causing widespread panic and civilian flight?
[KT1.1]
- ☐ 28. Who read the Declaration of Independence establishing the State of Israel in Tel Aviv on 14 May 1948?
[KT1.1]
- ☐ 29. What happened on 15 May 1948, the day after Israel declared its independence?
[KT1.1]
- ☐ 30. How did the first UN-negotiated truce in June 1948 provide Israel with a decisive operational advantage?
[KT1.1]
- ☐ 31. Which UN mediator was assassinated in Jerusalem in September 1948 by the radical Jewish militant group Lehi (Stern Gang)?
[KT1.1]
- ☐ 32. What was the name of the official border established by the 1949 Armistice Agreements between Israel and its Arab neighbors?
[KT1.1]
- ☐ 33. By the end of the 1948–49 Arab-Israeli War, what percentage of mandatory Palestine was controlled by Israel?
[KT1.1]
- ☐ 34. Which Arab military force proved to be the most effective and well-trained during the 1948–49 War, successfully holding the Old City of Jerusalem?
[KT1.1]
- ☐ 35. What was the 'Sergeants Affair' of July 1947, which caused widespread outrage in Britain?
[KT1.1]
- ☐ 36. What happened to the territory designated for an independent Palestinian Arab state under UN Resolution 181 following the 1948–49 war?
[KT1.1]

KEY TOPIC 1: THE BIRTH OF THE STATE OF ISRAEL, 1945–63

Complete Knowledge Retrieval Vault · Questions 41 to 80 (Self-mark on Pages 4–5)

VAULT PART 2

☐ 41. What Arabic term, meaning 'Catastrophe', is used to describe the expulsion and flight of approximately 700,000 Palestinians during the 1948–49 War?

[KT1.2]

☐ 43. Which United Nations agency was established in December 1949 to provide direct relief, education, and healthcare to displaced Palestinians?

[KT1.2]

☐ 45. What legislation passed by the Israeli Knesset in 1950 allowed the state to take custody of land and properties belonging to displaced Palestinian Arabs?

[KT1.2]

☐ 47. Why was the 1952 Reparations Agreement signed between Israel and West Germany so controversial inside Israel?

[KT1.2]

☐ 49. What was the primary goal of Israel's military 'reprisal policy' developed during the 1950s under Moshe Dayan and David Ben-Gurion?

[KT1.2]

☐ 51. Why was King Abdullah I of Jordan assassinated by a Palestinian gunman outside the Al-Aqsa Mosque in Jerusalem in July 1951?

[KT1.2]

☐ 53. What was the 'Tzena' regime in Israel between 1949 and 1953?

[KT1.2]

☐ 55. What was the impact of the February 1955 Israeli raid on Gaza (Operation Black Arrow) that killed 38 Egyptian soldiers?

[KT1.2]

☐ 57. Which Arab country formally granted full citizenship to the Palestinian refugees residing within its borders after 1949?

[KT1.2]

☐ 59. How did the United States support the young State of Israel economically in its immediate post-independence years?

[KT1.2]

☐ 61. What political revolution in July 1952 transformed Egypt from a pro-British monarchy into a radical nationalist republic?

[KT1.3]

☐ 63. What landmark September 1955 agreement shattered the Western arms monopoly in the Middle East and alarmed both Israel and the United States?

[KT1.3]

☐ 65. On what historic date did President Nasser nationalise the Suez Canal Company during a fiery speech in Alexandria?

[KT1.3]

☐ 67. Why was France eager to join a military operation against Nasser in 1956?

[KT1.3]

☐ 69. What was Operation Kadesh launched on 29 October 1956?

[KT1.3]

☐ 71. How did President Dwight D. Eisenhower and the United States respond to the Anglo-French military intervention at Suez?

[KT1.3]

☐ 73. What innovative peacekeeping body was created by the UN General Assembly in November 1956 to oversee the withdrawal of invading forces from Egypt?

[KT1.3]

☐ 75. What major political victory did Gamal Abdel Nasser achieve despite Egypt suffering defeat on the battlefield in 1956?

[KT1.3]

☐ 77. What was the 'Eisenhower Doctrine' announced by the US President in January 1957 following the Suez Crisis?

☐ 42. What was the core principle established by UN General Assembly Resolution 194 in December 1948 regarding Palestinian refugees?

[KT1.2]

☐ 44. What landmark Israeli law passed in July 1950 granted every Jewish individual worldwide the right to immigrate to Israel and receive citizenship?

[KT1.2]

☐ 46. What was Operation Magic Carpet (1949–1950)?

[KT1.2]

☐ 48. What term was used to describe armed Palestinian guerrilla raiders who crossed armistice lines to launch cross-border attacks against Israeli targets in the 1950s?

[KT1.2]

☐ 50. Which controversial Israeli commando raid in October 1953, led by Major Ariel Sharon and Unit 101, resulted in the dynamiting of houses and 69 civilian deaths in a West Bank village?

[KT1.2]

☐ 52. What was the 'Lavon Affair' (Operation Susannah) of 1954 in Egypt?

[KT1.2]

☐ 54. Under what legal framework did Palestinian Arab citizens who remained inside the State of Israel live between 1948 and 1966?

[KT1.2]

☐ 56. Which demographic group of Jewish immigrants faced significant discrimination, poor tent encampments (Ma'abarot), and social marginalization upon arrival in 1950s Israel?

[KT1.2]

☐ 58. What regional defense treaty, organized by Britain in 1955 to contain Soviet influence, was fiercely opposed by Egypt's Gamal Abdel Nasser as Western neo-colonialism?

[KT1.2]

☐ 60. What was the 'Tripartite Declaration' issued by Britain, France, and the United States in May 1950?

[KT1.2]

☐ 62. What major geopolitical ideology did President Nasser champion, advocating the political, cultural, and economic unification of all Arab peoples?

[KT1.3]

☐ 64. What decision by US Secretary of State John Foster Dulles in July 1956 directly triggered the Suez Crisis?

[KT1.3]

☐ 66. Why was British Prime Minister Sir Anthony Eden so personally hostile toward Gamal Abdel Nasser?

[KT1.3]

☐ 68. What secret collusion agreement was signed in October 1956 in a French villa between representatives of Britain, France, and Israel?

[KT1.3]

☐ 70. What did the joint Anglo-French ultimatum issued on 30 October 1956 demand of Egypt and Israel?

[KT1.3]

☐ 72. What threat did Soviet Premier Nikolai Bulganin make against Britain and France in November 1956 during the height of the crisis?

[KT1.3]

☐ 74. What was the ultimate geopolitical consequence of the 1956 Suez Crisis for Britain and France?

[KT1.3]

☐ 76. What conditions did Israeli Prime Minister David Ben-Gurion secure before agreeing to withdraw the IDF from Sinai and Gaza in March 1957?

[KT1.3]

☐ 78. What political union was formed in February 1958, uniting Egypt and Syria under President Nasser's single leadership?

KEY TOPIC 1: THE BIRTH OF THE STATE OF ISRAEL, 1945–63

Official Mark Scheme & Knowledge Reference · Answers 1 to 40 (Double-Sided Flip Reference)

MARK SCHEME 1

1. What crucial man-made waterway connects the Mediterranean Sea to the Red Sea, serving as a vital strategic chokepoint for international trade and oil?

Ans: The Suez Canal

3. Which triangular desert peninsula connecting Africa to Asia was captured by Israel from Egypt in 1956 and 1967, before being returned under the Camp David Accords?

Ans: The Sinai Peninsula

5. Which ancient and holy city, claimed as a capital by both Israelis and Palestinians, was divided between 1948 and 1967 before Israeli forces captured the Old City?

Ans: Jerusalem

7. Which narrow coastal strip bordering Egypt's Sinai Peninsula came under Egyptian military control in 1948, was captured by Israel in 1967, and became an epicenter of the 1987 Intifada?

Ans: The Gaza Strip

9. What was the de facto border established by the 1949 Armistice Agreements separating Israel from the West Bank, Gaza Strip, and Golan Heights until 1967?

Ans: The Green Line

11. Which southern Israeli port city on the Gulf of Aqaba provides Israel with maritime access to the Red Sea, East Africa, and Asia without using the Suez Canal?

Ans: Eilat

13. Which major freshwater lake in northern Israel, fed by the River Jordan, was a frequent source of border clashes with Syria in the 1950s and 1960s?

Ans: The Sea of Galilee (Lake Tiberias)

15. What was the massive Israeli chain of sand-wall fortifications built along the eastern bank of the Suez Canal after 1967 to defend against an Egyptian crossing?

Ans: The Bar-Lev Line

17. What was the political movement that emerged in the late 19th century advocating for the establishment of a sovereign Jewish national homeland in Palestine?

Ans: Zionism

19. Which neighboring Arab kingdom east of the River Jordan, ruled by King Abdullah I, annexed the West Bank and East Jerusalem following the 1948–49 War?

Ans: Transjordan (Jordan)

21. Why was British Foreign Secretary Ernest Bevin determined to maintain strict immigration quotas to Palestine in 1945–46?

Ans: To preserve British alliances with oil-rich Arab states and prevent regional conflict

23. Which refugee ship carrying 4,500 Holocaust survivors was intercepted by the British Royal Navy in July 1947 and forcibly returned to displaced persons camps in Germany?

Ans: The SS Exodus 1947

25. What was the Jewish Agency's reaction to UN Resolution 181 compared to that of the Arab Higher Committee?

Ans: The Jewish Agency accepted partition, whereas the Arab Higher Committee rejected it completely

27. What notorious event on 9 April 1948 involved an Irgun and Lehi attack on an Arab village, causing widespread panic and civilian flight?

Ans: The Deir Yassin massacre

29. What happened on 15 May 1948, the day after Israel declared its independence?

Ans: Armies from five neighboring Arab states invaded the newly declared State of Israel

31. Which UN mediator was assassinated in Jerusalem in September 1948 by the radical Jewish militant group Lehi (Stern Gang)?

Ans: Count Folke Bernadotte

33. By the end of the 1948–49 Arab-Israeli War, what percentage of mandatory Palestine was controlled by Israel?

Ans: Approximately 79%

2. Which strategic maritime passage at the mouth of the Gulf of Aqaba was blockaded by Egypt in 1956 and 1967, acts that Israel considered causes of war?

Ans: The Straits of Tiran

4. Which strategic river forms the natural eastern boundary of the West Bank, flowing south from the Sea of Galilee into the Dead Sea?

Ans: The River Jordan

6. Which elevated volcanic plateau bordering south-western Syria was captured by Israel during the 1967 Six Day War due to its dominant military vantage point over Galilee?

Ans: The Golan Heights

8. Which territory west of the River Jordan was annexed by Jordan in 1950, occupied by Israel in 1967, and became the central focus of Jewish settlement expansion?

Ans: The West Bank

10. Which arid southern desert region accounted for over 55% of the total land area allocated to the Jewish state under the 1947 UN Partition Plan?

Ans: The Negev Desert

12. Which strategic fortified coastal town at the southern tip of the Sinai Peninsula directly commands the entrance to the Straits of Tiran?

Ans: Sharm el-Sheikh

14. Which region north of Israel's border became known as 'Fatahland' in the 1970s as the PLO launched cross-border rocket attacks against northern Israeli towns?

Ans: Southern Lebanon

16. Which capital city was subjected to a brutal three-month siege and heavy IDF bombardment in the summer of 1982, leading to the evacuation of the PLO to Tunisia?

Ans: Beirut

18. What was the primary conflict between Arab and Jewish demands in Palestine as the British Mandate drew to a close in 1945?

Ans: Arabs demanded an independent democratic state based on majority rule, while Jews demanded an independent sovereign state to absorb Holocaust survivors

20. In 1945 at the end of the Second World War, what was the approximate demographic balance of the population living in Mandatory Palestine?

Ans: Approximately 1.2 million Palestinian Arabs and 600,000 Jews

22. What tragic event on 22 July 1946 broke British civilian morale and accelerated their withdrawal from Palestine?

Ans: The bombing of the King David Hotel in Jerusalem

24. What did United Nations Resolution 181 (passed on 29 November 1947) propose for Palestine?

Ans: Partitioning Palestine into separate Arab and Jewish states with Jerusalem under international control

26. What was the primary military objective of the Haganah's 'Plan Dalet' (Plan D) launched in April 1948?

Ans: To secure vital transport corridors (especially Tel Aviv-Jerusalem) and clear hostile villages prior to British departure

28. Who read the Declaration of Independence establishing the State of Israel in Tel Aviv on 14 May 1948?

Ans: David Ben-Gurion

30. How did the first UN-negotiated truce in June 1948 provide Israel with a decisive operational advantage?

Ans: It allowed Israel to reorganize the IDF, train conscripts, and import modern weapons from Czechoslovakia

32. What was the name of the official border established by the 1949 Armistice Agreements between Israel and its Arab neighbors?

Ans: The Green Line

34. Which Arab military force proved to be the most effective and well-trained during the 1948–49 War, successfully holding the Old City of Jerusalem?

KEY TOPIC 1: THE BIRTH OF THE STATE OF ISRAEL, 1945–63

Official Mark Scheme & Knowledge Reference · Answers 41 to 80

MARK SCHEME 2

41. What Arabic term, meaning 'Catastrophe', is used to describe the expulsion and flight of approximately 700,000 Palestinians during the 1948–49 War?

Ans: The Nakba

43. Which United Nations agency was established in December 1949 to provide direct relief, education, and healthcare to displaced Palestinians?
Ans: UNRWA (United Nations Relief and Works Agency)

45. What legislation passed by the Israeli Knesset in 1950 allowed the state to take custody of land and properties belonging to displaced Palestinian Arabs?
Ans: The Absentee Property Law

47. Why was the 1952 Reparations Agreement signed between Israel and West Germany so controversial inside Israel?
Ans: Many Israelis, led by Menachem Begin, viewed accepting German money as blood money for the Holocaust

49. What was the primary goal of Israel's military 'reprisal policy' developed during the 1950s under Moshe Dayan and David Ben-Gurion?
Ans: To deter future infiltration by launching disproportionately severe military counter-strikes against Arab border villages and bases

51. Why was King Abdullah I of Jordan assassinated by a Palestinian gunman outside the Al-Aqsa Mosque in Jerusalem in July 1951?
Ans: Because he was suspected of conducting secret bilateral peace negotiations with Israel

53. What was the 'Tzema' regime in Israel between 1949 and 1953?
Ans: A period of strict economic austerity, price controls, and food rationing to absorb hundreds of thousands of penniless immigrants

55. What was the impact of the February 1955 Israeli raid on Gaza (Operation Black Arrow) that killed 38 Egyptian soldiers?
Ans: It shattered Egyptian military pride and directly convinced President Nasser to seek modern weapons from the Soviet bloc

57. Which Arab country formally granted full citizenship to the Palestinian refugees residing within its borders after 1949?
Ans: Jordan

59. How did the United States support the young State of Israel economically in its immediate post-independence years?
Ans: By providing extensive grants, private bond sales, and a \$100 million Export-Import Bank loan

61. What political revolution in July 1952 transformed Egypt from a pro-British monarchy into a radical nationalist republic?
Ans: The Free Officers Revolution led by Gamal Abdel Nasser and Muhammad Naguib

63. What landmark September 1955 agreement shattered the Western arms monopoly in the Middle East and alarmed both Israel and the United States?
Ans: The Czechoslovak Arms Deal

65. On what historic date did President Nasser nationalise the Suez Canal Company during a fiery speech in Alexandria?
Ans: 26 July 1956

67. Why was France eager to join a military operation against Nasser in 1956?
Ans: France accused Nasser of providing crucial military and financial support to the FLN rebels in Algeria

69. What was Operation Kadesh launched on 29 October 1956?
Ans: The Israeli military invasion of the Sinai Peninsula, advancing rapidly toward the Suez Canal

71. How did President Dwight D. Eisenhower and the United States respond to the Anglo-French military intervention at Suez?
Ans: With fury, threatening to collapse the British economy by selling US sterling reserves unless troops withdrew

73. What innovative peacekeeping body was created by the UN General Assembly in November 1956 to oversee the withdrawal of invading forces

42. What was the core principle established by UN General Assembly Resolution 194 in December 1948 regarding Palestinian refugees?
Ans: Refugees wishing to return in peace should be permitted to do so, or be compensated for lost property

44. What landmark Israeli law passed in July 1950 granted every Jewish individual worldwide the right to immigrate to Israel and receive citizenship?
Ans: The Law of Return

46. What was Operation Magic Carpet (1949–1950)?
Ans: The secret airlift of approximately 50,000 Yemenite Jews to Israel

48. What term was used to describe armed Palestinian guerrilla raiders who crossed armistice lines to launch cross-border attacks against Israeli targets in the 1950s?
Ans: Fedayeen

50. Which controversial Israeli commando raid in October 1953, led by Major Ariel Sharon and Unit 101, resulted in the dynamiting of houses and 69 civilian deaths in a West Bank village?
Ans: The Qibya Raid

52. What was the 'Lavon Affair' (Operation Susannah) of 1954 in Egypt?
Ans: A covert Israeli military intelligence plot to bomb British and American targets in Egypt to frame the Muslim Brotherhood and stop British troop withdrawal

54. Under what legal framework did Palestinian Arab citizens who remained inside the State of Israel live between 1948 and 1966?
Ans: Under a strict system of Military Administration with curfews, travel permits, and special courts

56. Which demographic group of Jewish immigrants faced significant discrimination, poor tent encampments (Ma'abarot), and social marginalization upon arrival in 1950s Israel?
Ans: Mizrahi and Sephardic Jews from Arab and North African countries

58. What regional defense treaty, organized by Britain in 1955 to contain Soviet influence, was fiercely opposed by Egypt's Gamal Abdel Nasser as Western neo-colonialism?
Ans: The Baghdad Pact

60. What was the 'Tripartite Declaration' issued by Britain, France, and the United States in May 1950?
Ans: A pledge to regulate arms sales to both Arab states and Israel to prevent an arms race and oppose border changes by force

62. What major geopolitical ideology did President Nasser champion, advocating the political, cultural, and economic unification of all Arab peoples?
Ans: Pan-Arabism

64. What decision by US Secretary of State John Foster Dulles in July 1956 directly triggered the Suez Crisis?
Ans: The abrupt withdrawal of US and British financing for the Aswan High Dam

66. Why was British Prime Minister Sir Anthony Eden so personally hostile toward Gamal Abdel Nasser?
Ans: Eden viewed Nasser as a dangerous fascist dictator ('Mussolini on the Nile') who threatened Britain's imperial oil lifeline

68. What secret collusion agreement was signed in October 1956 in a French villa between representatives of Britain, France, and Israel?
Ans: The Protocol of Sèvres

70. What did the joint Anglo-French ultimatum issued on 30 October 1956 demand of Egypt and Israel?
Ans: That both sides stop fighting and withdraw their forces 10 miles away from the Suez Canal

72. What threat did Soviet Premier Nikolai Bulganin make against Britain and France in November 1956 during the height of the crisis?
Ans: He issued veiled threats that London and Paris were vulnerable to Soviet rocket strikes

74. What was the ultimate geopolitical consequence of the 1956 Suez Crisis for Britain and France?

Question 1: Consequence (4 Marks)

P-F-C Formula · ~6 Mins

Explain one consequence of the bombing of the King David Hotel (1946).

 **Level 1 Launchpad:** Starter: "One consequence was that it shattered British domestic and political resolve to maintain the Palestine Mandate."
Facts to Include: On 22 July 1946, Irgun militants disguised as milkmen detonated explosives in the basement, killing 91 British, Arab, and Jewish staff and destroying the British administrative secretariat.

One consequence was that...

Specifically, (include 2–3 historical facts)...

This was significant because it led directly to...

 **Level 3 (Grade 9) Stretch:** Grade 9 Nuance: Evaluate whether the British decision to quit Palestine was an intended or unintended consequence of the Irgun's insurgency, and whether economic exhaustion after WW2 made withdrawal inevitable anyway.

Question 2: Importance (8 Marks)

F-I-L Formula · ~12 Mins

Explain the importance of UN Resolution 181 for the creation of Israel.

 **Level 1 Launchpad:** Starter: "UN Resolution 181 was important for the creation of Israel because it provided essential international legal legitimacy for sovereign statehood."
Facts to Include: Passed by a 2/3 UN majority on 29 November 1947, allocating 55% of Mandatory Palestine to a Jewish state, 45% to an Arab state, and designating Jerusalem an international corpus separatum under UN administration.

This event was important for the outcome because...

For example, (provide precise factual knowledge)...

Without this development, the outcome would have differed because...

 **Level 3 (Grade 9) Stretch:** Grade 9 Evaluation: Counter-factual analysis — explain whether Resolution 181 secured peace or whether its rejection by Arab states guaranteed that statehood could only be finalized through military warfare in 1948–49.

Question 3: Narrative Account (8 Marks)

T-P-C Storyboard · ~12 Mins

Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Arab-Israeli war (1948–49).

You may use the following in your answer: • The invasion by Arab armies (May 1948) • The June 1948 truce (You must also use information of your own.)

Stage 1: The Outbreak (May 1948)

On 15 May 1948, armies from Egypt, Transjordan, Syria, Lebanon, and Iraq invaded simultaneously; Arab forces besieged 100,000 Jews in Jerusalem and advanced towards Tel Aviv.

Stage 2: The Turning Point (June 1948)

A 4-week UN truce enabled Israel to secretly import Avia S-199 fighters and rifles from Czechoslovakia, while David Ben-Gurion unified Haganah, Irgun, and Lehi into the IDF.

Stage 3: Outcome & Green Line (1948–49)

IDF counter-offensives broke the siege of Jerusalem via the Burma Road and secured 1949 armistices enclosing 79% of Palestine, creating 700,000 Palestinian refugees (the Nakba).

Causal Connectives Bank: This triggered an immediate... • A decisive turning point occurred when... • Consequently, this enabled the IDF to... • The culmination of this development was...

Paragraph 1: The crisis / conflict began when...

Paragraph 2: A decisive turning point occurred when...

Paragraph 3: As a direct consequence of this...

Level 3 (Grade 9) Analytical Glue: Grade 9 Analytical Glue: Avoid writing a descriptive chronological story. Explicitly explain the CAUSAL LINK between the June truce breathing space and Israel's tactical dominance in the autumn counter-offensives.

Question 1: Consequence (4 Marks)

Independent Toolkit

Explain one consequence of the Israeli attacks on Gaza in 1955.

Fact Vault (AO1)

- 28 February 1955: IDF paratroopers under Ariel Sharon raided an Egyptian military camp in Gaza.
- 38 Egyptian soldiers and 8 Israelis were killed, exposing severe Egyptian military deficiencies.
- Convinced President Nasser that Western arms embargos left Egypt vulnerable to Israeli aggression.

⚠️ **Trap:** Do not describe how the raid was carried out; focus solely on the political and military consequence for Nasser.

One consequence was...

Specifically,...

This was significant because...

Grade 9 Upgrade: Explain how this raid directly drove Nasser to seek Soviet-bloc weaponry, culminating in the September 1955 Czech Arms Deal and triggering the countdown to the Suez Crisis.

Question 2: Importance (8 Marks)

Independent Toolkit

Explain the importance of the Law of Return (1950) for the new state of Israel.

Fact Vault (AO1)

- Passed by Knesset on 5 July 1950: granted every Jewish person worldwide the legal right to settle in Israel as an automatic citizen.
- Doubled Israel's population within four years, absorbing 680,000 immigrants including European Holocaust survivors and Mizrahi/Sephardic refugees expelled from Arab nations.
- Created vital military manpower for the newly formed IDF and established demographic security against surrounding Arab majorities.

⚠️ **Trap:** Ensure your answer links directly to the survival and development OF THE NEW STATE, rather than writing a general history of immigration.

This event was important for the outcome because...

Specifically,...

As a direct result,...

Grade 9 Upgrade: Balance the military and demographic security advantages against the severe economic strain (ma'abarot tent cities, strict food rationing) it placed on the fledgling state.

Question 3: Narrative Account (8 Marks)

Chronological Anchor Toolkit

Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Suez Crisis (1956).

Stimulus Points: • Nationalisation of the Suez Canal (July 1956) • The Protocol of Sèvres (October 1956)

Chronological Anchors

- July 1956: Nasser nationalises Suez Canal after US withdraws Aswan Dam funding.
- Oct 1956: Protocol of Sèvres: Britain, France, and Israel secret collusion agreement.
- Oct–Nov 1956: Israel invades Sinai; Anglo-French ultimatum and paratrooper landings at Port Said.
- Nov 1956: US financial sanctions and UN pressure force humiliating Anglo-French withdrawal.

Causal Bridges

- "Nasser's nationalisation prompted..."
- "This led directly to secret tripartite collusion when..."
- "However, the military advance was halted when..."

Level 3 Standard: To achieve Level 3 (7–8 marks): Your account must explain how superpower intervention (US threats to collapse the British pound) converted an Anglo-French military victory into a political defeat.

The crisis / war began when...

A critical turning point occurred when...

Consequently, this led to...

KEY TOPIC 1: THE BIRTH OF THE STATE OF ISRAEL, 1945–63

Round 3: The Planning Engine Room · Causal Architecture (Plan here, write on Page 11)

ROUND 3: ENGINE ROOM

1. 4-Mark Consequence Planning Grid: Explain one consequence of the formation of the United Arab Republic (UAR) in 1958.

Point (Sentence 1)	2-3 Specific Historical Facts (AO1)	Causal Link to Outcome (AO2)
One consequence was that it encircled Israel with a unified Pan-Arab political union under President Nasser.	Egypt and Syria merged into a single state in February 1958, placing Egyptian military commanders in control of Syria's southern border with northern Israel.	This heightened Israeli security fears of a coordinated two-front war and pushed Israel to seek closer defensive ties with the United States and France.

2. 8-Mark Importance Planning Grid: Explain the importance of the creation of the Israeli Defence Forces (IDF) for the aftermath of the 1948–49 war.

Core Factor	Factual Information (Names, Dates, Treaties)	Direct Link to Named Outcome
The IDF was important because it dissolved competing political militias into a unified, disciplined national army under state control.	Established by David Ben-Gurion's Order No. 4 on 26 May 1948, forcibly disbanding the Haganah, Irgun, and Lehi (culminating in the Altalena affair), and introducing universal conscription.	This prevented factional civil war among Jewish groups, established firm civilian political control over the military, and created a permanent standing force capable of defending armistice borders.

3. 8-Mark Narrative Storyboard Grid: Write a narrative account analysing the key events leading to the end of the British Mandate in Palestine (1945–48).

Stage 1: Catalyst / Outbreak	Stage 2: Decisive Pivot	Stage 3: Climax & Outcome
Post-war Holocaust survivors sought entry; British White Paper strictly limited immigration to 1,500/month, triggering illegal Aliyah Bet ships (e.g. SS Exodus) and militant Jewish insurgency.	Irgun and Lehi launched guerrilla warfare against British infrastructure, climaxing in the July 1946 King David Hotel bombing and the hanging of two British sergeants in 1947.	Facing economic crisis at home and international outrage over turning back refugee ships, Britain announced in February 1947 it would surrender the Mandate, referring Palestine to the UN.

 **PRE-FLIGHT AUDIT CHECKLIST:** ☐ Did I include 2 precise dates/statistics per question? ☐ Does Q2 explain importance FOR THE SPECIFIC PROMPT? ☐ Does Q3 show how Stage 1 caused Stage 2?

KEY TOPIC 1: THE BIRTH OF THE STATE OF ISRAEL, 1945–63

Round 3: The Exam Pitch · Authentic Edexcel Continuous Prose Simulation

EXAM CONDITIONS

AO1 Knowledge (Level 3 Standard): Accurate, specific, and detailed historical facts deployed throughout.	AO2 Analysis (Level 3 Standard): Sustained causal focus, explaining consequence, importance, and causal flow.
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Question 1 (4 Marks):

Question 2 (8 Marks):

Question 3 (8 Marks):

TOP 3 FATAL EXAMINER TRAPS TO AVOID FOR KT1

• Partition (1947) vs Armistice (1949)

Do not confuse the 1947 UN Partition Plan (Res 181, which allocated 55% of Mandatory Palestine to a Jewish state) with the 1949 Armistice Green Line (which enclosed 79% following the 1948–49 War). Res 181 was never implemented as Arab leaders rejected it.

• The Turning Point of the 1948–49 War

The decisive turning point of the 1948–49 War was NOT superior Israeli numbers at the outbreak, but the 4-week UN truce in June 1948. This allowed Israel to import Czech Avia S-199 fighters and rifles, while David Ben-Gurion unified all militias into the IDF.

• Suez 1956: Military Victory vs Political Defeat

Britain and France achieved total military victory in capturing Port Said in November 1956, but suffered a catastrophic political humiliation when US President Eisenhower threatened financial sanctions, forcing an immediate withdrawal and elevating Nasser into a Pan-Arab hero.

SPECIFICATION PRACTICE BANK: 100% CURRICULUM COVERAGE

Every remaining specification bullet point tested below

Question 1: Explain one consequence of the conflicting interests and demands of Jews and Arabs within the British Mandate.

Consequence (4m)

Question 2: Explain one consequence of the territorial changes resulting from the 1948–49 war.

Consequence (4m)

Question 3: Explain the importance of the refugee status of Palestinian Arabs for relations between Israel and Arab states after 1949.

Importance (8m)

Question 4: Explain the importance of US aid to Israel in the period 1949–1963.

Importance (8m)

Question 5: Explain one consequence of Nasser's leadership of the Arab world for relations with Israel.

Consequence (4m)

Question 6: Explain the importance of the Israeli attacks on Sinai in 1956 for Israeli security.

Importance (8m)

Question 7: Write a narrative account analysing the development of Israel's relations with Egypt between 1949 and 1956.

Narrative (8m)

PUPIL ACTION PLAN & TARGET AREAS FOR REVISION

My weakest topic in this unit was...

The specific facts / dates I need to re-learn are...

My target for the upcoming exam paper is...